

A3 The USA, 1918–41

What students need to study:

- | | | |
|----------|---|---|
| 1 | The Roaring Twenties | The economic benefits of the First World War. Reasons for economic boom in the 1920s, Henry Ford and mass production, hire purchase, advertising, consumerism and the popularity of the stock market. Problems in farming, including over-production and mechanisation. The decline of older industries. The leisure industry, cinema, jazz, dancing, sport, radio, advertising and motoring. The changing position of women, including the flappers. |
| 2 | Increased social tensions in the 1920s | Attitudes and policies towards immigration. The Palmer Raids and the 'Red Scare'. The Sacco and Vanzetti Case. Attitudes towards black Americans. The Ku Klux Klan. Morals and values and the 'Monkey Trial'. Prohibition and the gangsters. |
| 3 | The USA in Depression, 1929–33 | The causes and consequences of the Wall Street Crash (1929–30). Hoover's reaction to the Great Depression: intervention and volunteerism. The impact of the Depression on banking, agriculture, industry and on people's lives: Hoovervilles and the Bonus Marchers, unemployment and homelessness. |
| 4 | Roosevelt and the New Deal, 1933–41 | Roosevelt's aims. The Hundred Days, the Alphabet Agencies, including the TVA and policies to deal with agriculture industry and unemployment. The second New Deal, including the Works Progress Administration, welfare for the poor, the old and farmers. The impact of the Social Security Act, the National Labor Relations Act ("Wagner Act") and the Banking Act of 1935. Rural electrification . The achievements and shortcomings of the New Deal. |
| 5 | The Opposition to the New Deal | The opposition of the Supreme Court, Republicans, business interests, the Liberty League; radical criticism such as Huey Long's Share Our Wealth programme and Father Coughlin's Social Justice campaign. |
-